Omar Sharaf

Director of Data Engineering · AI/ML & MLOps

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SUMMARY

Director of Data Engineering and AI/ML leader with 7+ years at Fortune 100 insurance and healthcare companies. Builds and leads high-performing engineering teams that ship production Generative AI and machine-learning systems: delivered six Gen AI applications in 18 months and doubled the number of models in production. Cuts critical production runtimes from hours to minutes and brings AI-native engineering practices to data teams. AWS certified; M.S. in Data Science in progress.

CORE SKILLS

Leadership: Engineering Management, Hiring & Team Building, Mentorship & Coaching, Agile / SAFe, Product Ownership, Stakeholder Partnership

AI/ML: Generative AI, RAG, LLM Applications, MLOps, Real-time & Batch Model Deployment

Cloud & Data: AWS, Databricks, Snowflake, Terraform, Docker, Neo4j, MongoDB, Teradata, Hadoop

Languages & Tools: Python, SQL, TypeScript, JavaScript, R, CI/CD, Tableau, Angular

EXPERIENCE

Director of Data Engineering — Pricing Model Support Feb 2026 – Present
The Travelers Companies Hartford, CT (Hybrid)

- Established engineering standards within two weeks on an inherited team with no testing or delivery controls: CI/CD pipelines, code-quality gates, and production-release controls.
- Hired four engineers directly and lead a team of five; onboarded and upskilled the team on AI-native development with Claude and related tools.
- Cut a critical production job from up to 8 hours to 30 minutes, turning chronically missed SLAs into consistently met ones.
- Reduced an 11-hour model run to 1 hour 40 minutes, letting the business run models and make decisions during the workday instead of overnight.
- Converted a data scientist's prototype into production-grade code in under 24 hours using Claude Code, validated and approved by data science.
- Introduced Agile sprints and act as product owner, defining epics and features with the business while staying hands-on in code.
- Serve as the trusted engineering partner to actuaries and data scientists, and coach engineers across lines of business to raise engineering standards.

Technical Engineering Manager — Gen AI / MLOps Aug 2024 – Feb 2026
The Travelers Companies Hartford, CT (Hybrid)

- Led four teams spanning data products, AI intake pipelines, and Gen AI applications (up to 11 engineers), owning delivery, performance reviews, and technical direction after a leadership transition.
- Doubled the number of ML models in production, clearing the full pricing backlog until data science had no models left to deploy.
- Built reusable deployment patterns that cut model-to-production time to under 24 hours with no added headcount.
- Delivered six Gen AI applications in 18 months across RAG and AI intake use cases, including the company's first Gen AI application released to external brokers.
- Served on the hiring panel that selected 10–15 high-performing engineers.
- Drove adoption of GitHub Copilot and early AI tooling, improving team efficiency and engineers' technical depth.

Cloud Data Engineer — Gen AI / MLOps Mar 2024 – Aug 2024
The Travelers Companies Hartford, CT (Hybrid)

- Led development and deployment of real-time and batch machine-learning models on the company's MLOps platform.
- Served as lead developer on the company's first RAG application, built on GPT-3.5.
- Partnered with business stakeholders to set technical priorities, mentored junior engineers, and streamlined new-hire onboarding.

Data Engineer Oct 2022 – Mar 2024
The Travelers Companies Hybrid, United States

- Built a Python tool that automated conversion of SQL Server DDLs to a new data storage platform, eliminating manual migration work.
- Developed a Neo4j-backed API and web frontend that visualizes database hierarchy and improves data visibility for engineering teams.
- Created an automated testing framework and set Snowflake deployment standards across the line of business.
- Stepped in as interim lead for two teams during a leadership transition.

Data Engineer Jun 2021 – Sep 2022
The Cigna Group (CGI Inc consultant) Bloomfield, CT

- Designed Python automation tools and frameworks that shortened development cycles and saved hundreds of engineering hours annually.
- Built ETL procedures that extract and transform base-table data for downstream applications, enforcing database development standards.
- Delivered incrementally in SAFe Agile teams.

Programmer Analyst Jun 2018 – Jun 2021
The Cigna Group (CGI Inc consultant) Bloomfield, CT

- Built Python REST APIs serving data from Hadoop, Teradata, and Oracle.
- Developed Angular applications and reusable components in Docker containers.
- Delivered business-critical reporting through Hadoop ELT and Tableau.
- Deployed and troubleshot CI/CD pipelines for Angular apps and Python APIs.

EDUCATION

M.S., Data Science (in progress), Central Connecticut State University Jan 2022 – Present
B.A., Economics, University of Connecticut Aug 2014 – Dec 2019

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner, Amazon Web Services Apr 2021